The whole earth smelled wet and fresh and even the normally serious–looking people in the village went around with smiles on their faces. The hole in the ground collected the water that fell and around its edges the grass grew a brighter green. Soon buffaloes discovered the grassy spot and as buffaloes want to do, they **wallowed** in the puddly water, turning the hole into a muddy pit.

I was not there to see, but I am told that many afternoons did the buffaloes gather and thus with a **multitude** of hooves **trampling** the soil, the pit that was once a tiny depression, widened and grew and became a little watering hole.

"And they all lived happily ever after!" you will say in glee. But that rarely happens in real tales, my dear. There is more to go, so you will have to wait awhile.

Complete the sentences given below with words/phrases.

The wild dogs came to the spot to catch_____.

The rains came and poured_____.

The whole earth smelled _____ and _____.

The hole in the ground was filled _____.

The buffalo _____ in the hole.

The hole became _____ and _____.

Section III

Read this section in pairs.



A poor farmer **tilled** the land near the once small depression. His life was hard and the rains were often cruel. In summer months he had to travel far to get water for his thirsty crops and even then his harvest was **meagre**. One day, not long after the last of the season's rains, he straightened up from his back-breaking work and looked over the land that was soon becoming brown again. And on the horizon, just beyond his pitiful plot, his eyes came to rest on a patch of green. Going closer to investigate, the farmer fell to the ground with **gratitude** at

GLOSSARY

wallowed	- to lie and roll in mud	tilled	- prepared the land for crops
multitude	- a large number of people	meagre	- small quantity
trampling	- crushing	gratitude	- thankful

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